

RELIGION WITHOUT GOD

DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST → FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS → BUDDHISM → JAINISM, MĪMĀṂSĀ AND SĀṂKHYA → CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE → NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g12 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST

DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST CAN RELIGION EXIST WITHOUT A CREATOR GOD? RELIGION MAY ORGANISE ULTIMATE CONCERN SACRED VALUE MORAL DISCIPLINE WORLDVIEW THEISM IS SUFFICIENT FOR MANY RELIGIONS, NOT CONCEPTUALLY NECESSARY
ATHEISTIC; SILENCE, IRRELEVANCE AND DENIAL ARE DIFFERENT POSITIONS.

CAN RELIGION EXIST WITHOUT A CREATOR GOD?

religion may organise

ultimate concern

sacred value

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CAN RELIGION EXIST WITHOUT A CREATOR GOD?
- religion may organise
- ultimate concern

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- sacred value
- moral discipline worldview
- THEISM is sufficient for many religions, not conceptually necessary for all test a tradition by doctrine + practice

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- + soteriology, not by a Western creator template
- TRAP: non-theistic != atheistic; silence, irrelevance and denial are different positions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Non-theistic religion is not identical with atheism: absence, irrelevance, denial and suspension of God-belief are distinct positions.

01

STAGE 01 FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS

FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS DENIES THAT GOD EXISTS SUSPENDS JUDGEMENT BECAUSE KNOWLEDGE/EVIDENCE IS INSUFFICIENT GOD IS ABSENT OR NON-CENTRAL TO THE PATH HOLDS GOD-BELIEF HARMFUL OR FALSE IN A STRONGER EVALUATIVE
"GOD" MUST BE MADE MEANINGFUL BEFORE EXISTENCE IS DEBATED LIFE ORGANISED WITHOUT REFERENCE TO GOD KEEP EPISTEMIC SUSPENSION

ATHEISM: denies that God exists

AGNOSTICISM: suspends judgement because knowledge/evidence is insufficient

NON-THEISM: God is absent or non-central to the path

ANTI-THEISM: holds God-belief harmful or false in a stronger evaluative sense

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ATHEISM: denies that God exists
- AGNOSTICISM: suspends judgement because knowledge/evidence is insufficient

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NON-THEISM: God is absent or non-central to the path
- ANTI-THEISM: holds God-belief harmful or false in a stronger evaluative sense

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- IGNOSTICISM: "God" must be made meaningful before existence is debated practical atheism: life organised without reference to God
- keep epistemic suspension separate from metaphysical denial.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Agnosticism suspends judgement about God's existence or knowability; unlike atheism, it withholds assent rather than asserting denial.

02

STAGE 02 BUDDHISM

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS DEPENDENT ORIGATION EIGHTFOLD PATH NIRVĀṆA NO ETERNAL CREATOR IS NEEDED; SUFFERING HAS CONDITIONED BUDDHA REJECTS SPECULATIVE QUESTIONS WHEN THEY DO NOT CONDUCE KARMA/ORDER FUNCTIONS LIKE HIDDEN PROVIDENCE REPLY
CAUSAL-MORAL REGULARITY IS IMPERSONAL; NO OMNIPOTENT ALLOCATOR OR CREATOR

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS → dependent origination → eightfold path → nirvāṇa no eternal creator is

suffering has conditioned causes, not divine decree devas may occur in cosmology but are impermanent

Buddha rejects speculative questions when they do not conduce to cessation of duḥkha objection: karma/order

no omnipotent allocator or creator follows.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS → dependent origination → eightfold path → nirvāṇa no eternal creator is needed
- suffering has conditioned causes, not divine decree devas may occur in cosmology but are impermanent and unsaving

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Buddha rejects speculative questions when they do not conduce to cessation of duḥkha objection: karma/order functions like hidden
- no omnipotent allocator or creator follows.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS → dependent origination → eightfold path → nirvāṇa no eternal creator is needed
- suffering has conditioned causes, not divine decree devas may occur in cosmology but are impermanent and unsaving

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dependent origination and karma (action and moral causation) make a creator explanatorily unnecessary, while ethics, meditation, community and nirvāṇa (liberation from suffering) preserve a fully religious form of life.

03

03

STAGE 03

JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀṂKHYA

JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀṂKHYA

ETERNAL JĪVA/AJĪVA; KARMIC MATTER; TĪRTHAṆKARA TEACHES, NOT CREATES

AUTHORLESS ETERNAL VEDA; RITUAL ACTION GENERATES APŪRVA; NO DIVINE

PRAKṚTI EVOLVES FOR PLURAL PURUṢAS; UNCONSCIOUS TELEOLOGY WITHOUT CREATOR

IF GOD IS PERFECT, WHY CREATE? IF EMBODIED, WHO

JAINISM RETAINS WORSHIPFUL EXEMPLARS; MĪMĀMSĀ CENTRES DHARMA/RITUAL

SĀṂKHYA CENTRES DISCRIMINATIVE METAPHYSICS AND KAIVALYA.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
JAINISM: eternal jīva/ajīva; karmic matter; tīrthāṇkara teaches, not creates	unconscious teleology without creator shared anti-creator pressure: if God is perfect, why create?	Sāṁkhya centres discriminative metaphysics and kaivalya.
MĪMĀMSĀ: authorless eternal Veda; ritual action generates apūrva; no divine author needed	if embodied, who made body?	
SĀṂKHYA: prakṛti evolves for plural puruṣas	distinctions: Jainism retains worshipful exemplars; Mīmāṃsā centres dharma/ritual	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- JAINISM: eternal jīva/ajīva; karmic matter; tīrthāṇkara teaches, not creates
- MĪMĀMSĀ: authorless eternal Veda; ritual action generates apūrva; no divine author needed
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DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- unconscious teleology without creator shared anti-creator pressure: if God is perfect, why create?
- if embodied, who made body?
- distinctions: Jainism retains worshipful exemplars; Mīmāṃsā centres dharma/ritual

EVALUATION / TRAP

- Sāṁkhya centres discriminative metaphysics and kaivalya.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism, Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school) and Sāṁkhya (enumeration-based dualist school) show that liberation, scripture, ritual and cosmic explanation can be organised without a creator deity.

04

04

STAGE 04

CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE

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CĀRVĀKA DENIES GOD, AFTERLIFE, KARMA, VEDIC AUTHORITY AND MOKṢA

DOES IT COUNT AS RELIGION?

DOCTRINAL-HISTORICAL MEMBER OF INDIAN PHILOSOPHICAL DEBATE

YES SACRED/TRANSCENDENT/SOTERIOLOGICAL PRACTICE IN ROBUST SENSE

LARGELY NO LIMIT CASE SHOWS THAT "PHILOSOPHY WITHOUT GOD"

BUDDHISM/JAINISM BETTER PRESERVE RITUAL, COMMUNITY AND LIBERATION FUNCTIONS.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- CĀRVĀKA denies God, afterlife, karma, Vedic authority and mokṣa embodied this-worldly flourishing replaces salvation - DOES IT COUNT AS RELIGION?	- doctrinal-historical member of Indian philosophical debate: YES sacred/transcendent/soteriological practice in robust sense: largely NO limit case shows that "philosophy without God" is easier than "religion without God"	- Buddhism/Jainism better preserve ritual, community and liberation functions. - CĀRVĀKA denies God, afterlife, karma, Vedic authority and mokṣa embodied this-worldly flourishing replaces salvation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Non-theistic traditions replace different divine functions separately—creation, authority, moral causation, worship or salvation—so 'religion without God' names several arguments rather than one model.

05

05

STAGE 05

NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

"GOD IS DEAD"

COLLAPSE OF THE CHRISTIAN-METAPHYSICAL VALUE HORIZON DANGER

NIHILISM, HERD MORALITY EXPOSED, NO TRANSCENDENT GUARANTOR TASK

REVALUATION OF VALUES

LIFE-AFFIRMATION NOT A SIMPLE EMPIRICAL PROOF THAT NO DEITY

SELF-CREATED VALUES RISK ARBITRARINESS OR DOMINATION REPLY

GENEALOGY TESTS INHERITED VALUES; AFFIRMATIVE CREATION ACCEPTS RESPONSIBILITY

"GOD IS DEAD" = collapse of the Christian-metaphysical value horizon danger: nihilism, herd morality exposed

affirmative creation accepts responsibility

POST-THEISM asks what religious depth survives after classical supernatural belief.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
"GOD IS DEAD" = collapse of the Christian-metaphysical value horizon danger: nihilism, herd morality exposed, no transcendent guarantor - affirmative creation accepts responsibility	- POST-THEISM asks what religious depth survives after classical supernatural belief. "GOD IS DEAD" = collapse of the Christian-metaphysical value horizon danger: nihilism, herd morality exposed, no transcendent guarantor	- affirmative creation accepts responsibility - POST-THEISM asks what religious depth survives after classical supernatural belief.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nietzsche's 'death of God' is a diagnosis of the collapse of a value-horizon, not merely a proof of atheism; its unresolved task is the non-arbitrary revaluation of values.

06

06

STAGE 06

NATURALISM AND FICTIONALISM

